

CHALLENGES

Explore the six corporate challenge descriptions, strategic questions, and market contexts below.

MOBILITY / TRANSPORTATION — URBAN SUPER-APP

bolt.eu ↗

Bolt: Shared Urban Mobility Ecosystems

As Europe's leading transportation super-app spanning ride-hailing, micromobility (e-scooters and e-bikes), and food delivery, Bolt aims to accelerate the transition away from personal car ownership towards shared, sustainable urban transit networks across European municipalities.

Core Mission: Creating shared transit models that are faster, greener, and more economical than owning a private passenger car in dense European cities.

KEY CHALLENGE AREAS

- **Multimodal Urban Integration:** Connecting micromobility hubs with municipal public transit networks and unified city ticketing platforms.
- **Operational Sustainability & Fleet Utilization:** Optimizing shared battery swap logistics, prolonging fleet lifespans, and minimizing lifecycle CO2 emissions.
- **User Habit Formation:** Developing dynamic pricing algorithms and subscription tiers that incentivize daily commutes through shared mobility over personal car use.

BuukAI: Autonomous Accounting for the Borderless Digital Economy

BuukAI delivers AI-powered automated bookkeeping, pan-European VAT compliance, and real-time payroll systems for digital entrepreneurs, e-commerce stores, and cross-border startups. The goal is to eliminate manual compliance friction and automate financial operations through conversational AI.

The Market Problem: Cross-border digital businesses spend hours reconciling multi-currency payouts, fragmented invoices, and varying EU tax regimes using fragmented, outdated software.

KEY CHALLENGE AREAS

- **Autonomous Bookkeeping Accuracy:** Structuring AI validation layers that achieve near-zero hallucination rates when interpreting unstructured financial documents and receipts.
- **Go-to-Market in Fragmented EU Regimes:** Formulating an aggressive market-entry strategy across varied national accounting standards and e-invoicing mandates (e.g., ViDA initiative).
- **Monetization & Trust:** Developing pricing architectures (tiered usage vs. fee-per-transaction) that attract early-stage ventures while inspiring institutional financial trust.

eu-LISA: Resilient, Human-Centric Mission-Critical Border Tech

Headquartered in Tallinn, eu-LISA manages Europe's mission-critical large-scale IT infrastructure supporting internal security, visa policy, and border control (such as Schengen Information System SIS II, Visa Information System VIS, and Eurodac). The agency is exploring next-generation paradigms for ethical data governance, high-availability zero-trust architecture, and biometric processing.

The Public Sector Challenge: Delivering rapid, highly available digital border crossing technologies while strictly upholding fundamental rights, GDPR compliance, and biometric data sovereignty.

KEY CHALLENGE AREAS

- **Zero-Trust Interoperability:** Ensuring secure, seamless data exchange between national border authorities without creating centralized single-point-of-failure vulnerabilities.
- **Privacy-Preserving Verification:** Integrating zero-knowledge proof protocols and edge computing to authenticate traveler credentials without storing sensitive biometric templates.
- **Operational Resilience & Scalability:** Scaling system architecture to process tens of millions of real-time border queries daily under stringent cyber-defense constraints.

ENERGY & COMPUTING — DISTRIBUTED AI CONTROL PLANE

greenpow.io ↗

GreenPow: Compute Without More Megawatts

GreenPow builds a control plane for distributed AI and enterprise compute. As AI demand grows, access to compute is increasingly constrained by electricity, grid

connections, data-center capacity, and deployment time. GreenPow orchestrates eligible workloads across time, approved locations, and infrastructure using signals such as energy availability, electricity cost, carbon intensity, compute capacity, infrastructure availability, performance requirements, latency, data sovereignty, and operational policies. Not every workload can move: some must run immediately or in a specific region, while others can shift when and where capacity or energy is more available. GreenPow's goal is to deliver more useful compute from constrained infrastructure while respecting performance, availability, security, and sovereignty requirements.

Core Challenge Question: How can organizations run more AI using the infrastructure and energy already available? Given GreenPow's existing ability to orchestrate eligible workloads, where should GreenPow apply this capability first, what should the customer-facing solution look like, and how can it become a scalable business?

CASE CONTEXT & SCOPE

GreenPow already develops the underlying orchestration capability. Teams are **not** expected to reproduce or redesign GreenPow's orchestration engine. Instead, treat this capability as the starting point and explore where it creates the strongest customer and business value. The market question remains open: which customers have the strongest need for flexible computing, which workloads matter most, what customer-facing product/service should expose this capability, how should value be measured, who should pay, and how to validate the first pilot?

KEY TASKS & FOCUS AREAS

- **1. Identify the Opportunity:** Determine who has the strongest problem and why it matters now. Identify the customer, the user, and the buyer. Explain their constraints, current workarounds, and willingness to pay.
- **2. Understand Where Flexibility Exists:** Use common workload examples provided by GreenPow to identify which computing tasks must run immediately, which can wait, which can run elsewhere, and which remain fixed, backed by regulatory and operational constraints.
- **3. Design the Solution:** Create the customer-facing solution (software, service, platform, marketplace, or managed offering) that directly connects GreenPow's orchestration engine to a real customer problem.
- **4. Build the Business Model:** Complete a Business Model Canvas defining value

propositions, segments, channels, partners, activities, revenue models, cost drivers, and key alternatives/competitors.

- **5. Quantify the Customer Value:** Demonstrate through simple calculations and explicit assumptions why the solution matters (serving more workloads, higher utilization, lower costs, or faster capacity access).
- **6. Design the First Pilot:** Propose a practical customer experiment: target customer, hypothesis, required data, critical metric, and success/stopping criteria.

EXPECTED OUTPUT & DELIVERABLES

Teams prepare a startup-style pitch and Business Model Canvas along with a lightweight prototype, mock-up, dashboard, calculator, customer journey, or simple demonstration making the proposed solution tangible (focusing on customer experience and business concept, not underlying engine algorithms). Every team will receive common workload examples and a simplified infrastructure/energy scenario.

MANUFACTURING — STEEL STRUCTURES & METAL PROCESSING

[maru.ee](#) ↗

Maru Metall AS: Smart & Circular Industrial Manufacturing

Maru Metall AS is a premier Nordic manufacturer of complex steel frameworks, industrial facilities, and architectural infrastructure. With European construction facing aggressive decarbonization targets and material volatility, the company seeks data-driven solutions to optimize custom manufacturing pipelines and enhance circular resource cycles.

The Industrial Challenge: Balancing high-precision structural steel manufacturing with EU Green Deal compliance, carbon transparency (EPDs), and efficient production shop floor scheduling.

KEY CHALLENGE AREAS

- **Digital Tracking & Carbon Accounting:** Designing scalable methods for tracking embodied carbon in raw steel batches to provide auditable digital material passports.
- **Smart Factory Optimization:** Leveraging predictive analytics and IoT to optimize cutting layouts, reduce scrap metal, and automate predictive maintenance.
- **Value-Added Service Business Models:** Transitioning from simple component manufacturing to lifecycle asset management, modular reuse, and refurbishment partnerships.

HOSPITALITY TECH / SAAS — EXPERIENCE ECONOMY

wayyo.app ↗

Wayyo: A Booking Platform for Independent Hosts

Wayyo is the easiest way for independent hosts to take and manage bookings online. It is a booking platform for solo and micro-operators in the experience economy: guided and walking tours, food and wine tastings, craft workshops, and similar session-based activities. Hosts get a shareable booking page built from templates or generated via AI prompt, plus a lightweight management dashboard.

The Core Friction: Wayyo is built for hosts who currently run operations on Google Forms, Instagram DMs, WhatsApp, and spreadsheets. The primary incumbent is not an enterprise software product, but a free DIY patchwork of consumer tools.

THE CENTRAL CHALLENGE: 3 LINKED STRATEGIC DECISIONS

- **Beachhead Strategy:** Which EU regions and experience sub-sectors (walking tours, gastronomy, outdoor adventure, artisan craft) offer the fastest and cheapest path to adoption, and on what evidence?
- **Acquisition Motion:** Should growth focus on direct digital acquisition, tourism associations/DMO partnerships, OTA adjacency, or host community content? What is the lead hook: AI page builder (acquisition) or dashboard (retention)?
- **Monetisation Ladder:** Pressure-test the free commission-based BASIC tier (roughly

2.89% on direct bookings) alongside paid tiers (PREMIUM at €14.99/mo; ALL INCLUDED at €24.99/mo) backed by simple unit economics.

Presentation Requirement: Each team will present a **3-minute pitch** reflecting the core Business Model Canvas aspects according to the four evaluation criteria.

Allocation: Equal team distribution (6–8 students per team) on a **"first come, first served"** basis.

[Explore the challenges](#)

[Choose your preferred one](#)

Instructions & evaluation



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